URBANKHET

Reworking UrbanKhet’s operation through COVID

Changing sourcing, routes and distribution when the original demand and delivery model no longer fitted.

Role: Founder & Director | Period: 2020–2021

Reported outcomes and scope

15 days · Reported logistics rebuild

≤10% · Reported produce wastage

An earlier CV compares this with an industry benchmark, not a measured company before/after baseline.

The product problem

The first COVID-19 wave disrupted UrbanKhet’s business-customer model and placed pressure on delivery and cash runway. The venture still had a team and ongoing customer commitments, while demand and routes changed under lockdown.

My role

I remained accountable for the operating model and team. The Professional Profile describes rebuilding logistics, creating new distribution partnerships and shifting routes based on daily volume.

What I built

The reported pivot rebuilt the logistics chain within 15 days and included decentralised delivery collaboration with Amul. Sourcing, customer demand and route planning had to be reconsidered as one system.

The founder records also describe SOPs and the distribution model used to keep perishable waste low. Later, the venture was wound down when its economics became unsustainable, rather than treating continued operation as the only possible outcome.

Changing the model as demand and access changed

I assessed the disruption to business-customer demand and the practical constraints on moving produce. The pivot put greater emphasis on direct consumer demand while revising distribution. Logistics partnerships and route planning were treated as part of the same change because a new order channel still needed a route that could fulfil the order.

The Professional Profile describes rebuilding that logistics chain within fifteen days and creating decentralised delivery collaboration with Amul. Delivery routes changed with daily volume. My responsibility as founder covered those decisions and the operating team together; a route adjustment or partnership was useful only if the service could continue under the new constraints.

Leadership through a changing operating reality

The 28-person team remained part of my founder remit while the venture changed its customer and delivery model. I continued operating the business, coordinating the team and revising the service under lockdown conditions. The people, customer commitments and economics were connected parts of that responsibility.

The later account records a decision to wind down after the second wave made the economics unsustainable. Ownership extended to assessing whether continued operation remained viable, as well as making the first-wave pivot. The precise closure sequence and stakeholder-settlement details remain bounded in the source notes.

What changed

The reported result is a fifteen-day logistics rebuild and first-wave delivery continuity. The later venture history also records a subsequent wind-down. This case preserves the operating response and the viability decision as separate parts of founder responsibility.

The lesson from this work

This case demonstrates responsibility for the whole service during a disruption. The documented decisions concern demand, routes, partnerships and economic viability, with the team and customer promise carried through the change.

Visual references and walkthroughs

UrbanKhet: Delivery straight outta khet — original Studio Sorted campaign art

UrbanKhet: Delivery straight outta khet — original Studio Sorted campaign art Campaign and brand artwork: Studio Sorted.

UrbanKhet: Urbankhet farmer market — original Studio Sorted campaign art

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Documented workflow: Changed supply and delivery constraints → Rebuild sourcing and routes → Decentralised delivery partners → Operating SOPs and coordination → Continuity and waste control

An authored explanation of the workflow described in this case study. This is a diagram, not a captured product screen.

View the online case study for the full image gallery and playable videos.

Evidence and attribution

Continuity and closure chronology vary between source versions; first-wave continuity is the narrower documented claim.

First-wave continuity and fifteen-day rebuild come from the later profile. Early and later CVs differ on second-wave/closure timing. No individual employee, creditor or supplier closure outcome is independently established.